

European Food

Unilever

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

ULVR.LN

5,800.00 GBp

UNA.NA

66.90 EUR



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Unilever (ULVR.LN) 1H/2Q26: Light at the end of the tunnel?

Unilever reported its 1H/2Q26 results this morning with a strong set of numbers. After a challenging eighteen months in the wake of the unexpected removal of former CEO Hein Schumacher, and the volatility induced by the spin-off of ice-cream and Foods sale, these much stronger than expected results seem likely to drive a significant uptick in positivity today, and perhaps even induce investors to look beyond the noise of the ongoing Foods sale process.

Q2 Organic sales growth at +5.8%, led by +5.5% volume growth. The group delivers a stark acceleration in volume and sales growth for the second quarter, up from +3.8% and +2.9% in Q1, respectively. This stark acceleration is dramatically ahead of consensus' forecasts, which had put OSG at 4.1%, and had foreseen a slowdown in volume growth for the quarter. We can't remember the last time one of our Staples coverage companies beat consensus volume estimates by 300+bps! Importantly, at a divisional level, the strength is driven by the HPC business that will remain in the wake of the Foods sale. "HPCCo" delivers an impressive +7.6% OSG, and beats on organic volume growth by over 400bps, with all HPC divisions much stronger than expected. By contrast, we expect that there will be some questions around performance of the Foods business, which is the only blot on the metaphorical copy book this quarter. On a regional basis, both developed and emerging markets see acceleration in the quarter, but India (+10%) and LatAm (+8.9%) are both notably strong, and North America sees a return to strong volume growth in the quarter following a couple of quarters of weakness. Margins are broadly in-line with expectations, leading to EBIT/EPS around 1% ahead of consensus.

Following the very strong Q2, FY Guidance is raised. Previously management had steered OSG to the bottom end of the long-term 4-6% range, with volume volumes at around 2%. Now volume growth guidance is raised to around 3%, and the emphasis on the low-end of the 4-6% range is removed. 2H growth is expected to be in the 4-5% range, and more skewed to pricing, which makes sense in the current cost environment we think.

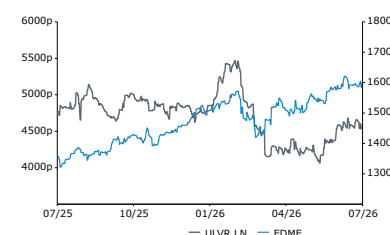
On net, the big volume acceleration is exactly what Staples investors have been impatiently waiting for over the past two years, and whilst there may be some questions about its sustainability, we expect it to drive a positive share price reaction today.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	25A	26E	27E
ULVR.LN (EUR)	3.08	3.23	3.45	Revenues (M)	50,503	51,933	54,570	--	EV/EBITDA (x)	13.9	13.8	12.9
UNA.NA (EUR)	3.08	3.23	3.45	Organic Sales Growth (%)	3.5	4.2	4.9	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	17.6	16.8	15.7
									Div Yield (%)	3.4	3.6	3.8

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	27 Jul 2026
ULVR.LN Close Price (GBp)	4,627.00
Price Target (GBp)	5,800.00
Upside/(Downside)	25%
52-Week Range	5,525.00/4,068.00
EDME	--
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	3.5%
Market Cap (GBP) (M)	99,678
EV (GBP) (M)	141,785
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	(4.8) 0.6 (4.9) (3.4)
EDME (%)	
Relative (%)	
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.	

Price Performance, 1YR



KEY NUMBERS:

Q2 Group organic growth of +5.8% came in +171bps ahead of consensus at +4.1%.

Q2 Group sales of EUR 13,046 million was +1.3% ahead of consensus at EUR 12,880 million.

EXHIBIT 1: ULVR Q2 sales summary versus consensus and Bernstein expectations

ULVR Q2 sales summary	2Q25	2Q26	YoY Δ	Consensus 2Q26	Δ	Bernstein 2Q26	Δ
Group (EUR m)	12,567	13,046	3.8%	12,880	1.3%	12,992	0.4%
Group (organic growth)	3.1%	5.8%	+270 bps	4.1%	+171 bps	4.3%	+153 bps
Price growth	2.1%	0.2%	-190 bps	1.7%	-148 bps	1.5%	-132 bps
Volume growth	1.1%	5.5%	+440 bps	2.4%	+310 bps	2.8%	+275 bps
Sales FX impact	-6.1%	-2.4%	+370 bps	-2.2%	-18 bps	-1.6%	-77 bps
Sales M&A impact	-2.3%	0.6%	+290 bps	0.7%	-7 bps	0.8%	-20 bps

Prior year sales and growth stated ex. Ice Cream.

Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha consensus, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 2: Unilever H1 result summary vs consensus and Bernstein estimates

Unilever H1 result summary	2025 H1	2026 H1	YoY Δ	Consensus 1H26	Δ	Bernstein 1H26	Δ
Group Sales (€ m)	25,506	25,623	0.5%	25,475	0.6%	25,554	0.3%
Group Underl. Op. Profit (€ m)	5,148	5,193	0.9%	5,169	0.5%	5,148	0.9%
Group Underl. OPM (%)	20.2%	20.3%	8 bps	20.3%	-2 bps	20.1%	12 bps
Diluted Underlying EPS (€)	1.59	1.61	1.3%	1.59	1.3%	1.60	0.4%

PY sales and operating profit stated ex. Ice Cream. PY EPS as reported.

Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha consensus, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 3: ULVR Q2 sales by product div. versus consensus and Bernstein expectations

ULVR Q2 sales by product div.	2Q25	2Q26	YoY Δ	Consensus 2Q26	Δ	Bernstein 2Q26	Δ
Group (EUR m)	12,567	13,046	3.8%	12,880	1.3%	12,992	0.4%
Beauty & Wellbeing	3,219	3,403	5.7%	3,290	3.4%	3,377	0.8%
Personal Care	3,296	3,535	7.3%	3,492	1.2%	3,392	4.2%
Home Care	2,865	3,009	5.0%	2,938	2.4%	2,997	0.4%
Foods	3,187	3,099	-2.8%	3,159	-1.9%	3,227	-4.0%
Group (organic growth)	3.1%	5.8%	+270 bps	4.1%	+171 bps	4.3%	+153 bps
Beauty & Wellbeing	3.4%	8.1%	+470 bps	4.6%	+353 bps	4.3%	+380 bps
Personal Care	4.5%	5.9%	+140 bps	4.9%	+103 bps	4.9%	+100 bps
Home Care	1.8%	9.1%	+730 bps	5.3%	+379 bps	5.5%	+360 bps
Foods	2.8%	0.2%	-260 bps	2.2%	-198 bps	2.5%	-230 bps
Group (Price Growth)	2.1%	0.2%	-190 bps	1.7%	-148 bps	1.5%	-132 bps
Beauty & Wellbeing	2.4%	1.1%	-130 bps	1.7%	-62 bps	1.6%	-50 bps
Personal Care	4.3%	-0.9%	-520 bps	2.5%	-336 bps	2.4%	-330 bps
Home Care	0.4%	0.5%	+10 bps	1.5%	-105 bps	1.0%	-50 bps
Foods	1.0%	0.2%	-80 bps	1.1%	-93 bps	1.0%	-80 bps
Group (Volume Growth)	1.1%	5.5%	+440 bps	2.4%	+310 bps	2.8%	+275 bps
Beauty & Wellbeing	1.0%	6.9%	+590 bps	2.8%	+409 bps	2.7%	+420 bps
Personal Care	0.2%	6.8%	+660 bps	2.4%	+442 bps	2.5%	+430 bps
Home Care	1.3%	8.6%	+730 bps	3.7%	+487 bps	4.5%	+410 bps
Foods	1.7%	-0.1%	-180 bps	1.0%	-113 bps	1.5%	-160 bps

Prior year sales and growth stated ex. Ice Cream.

Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha consensus, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 4: Unilever H1 results vs consensus and Bernstein estimates

Unilever H1 results	2025 H1	2026 H1	YoY Δ	Consensus 1H26	Δ	Bernstein 1H26	Δ
Group Sales (€ m)	25,506	25,623	0.5%	25,475	0.6%	25,554	0.3%
Beauty & Wellbeing	6,489	6,509	0.3%	6,405	1.6%	6,480	0.4%
Personal Care	6,545	6,817	4.2%	6,775	0.6%	6,670	2.2%
Home Care	5,904	5,992	1.5%	5,919	1.2%	5,974	0.3%
Foods	6,568	6,305	-4.0%	6,376	-1.1%	6,431	-2.0%
Group Underl. Op. Profit (€ m)	5,148	5,193	0.9%	5,169	0.5%	5,148	0.9%
Beauty & Wellbeing	1,256	1,269	1.0%	1,231	3.1%	1,251	1.5%
Personal Care	1,444	1,513	4.8%	1,518	-0.3%	1,467	3.1%
Home Care	915	944	3.2%	921	2.5%	938	0.7%
Foods	1,533	1,467	-4.3%	1,492	-1.7%	1,492	-1.7%
Group Underl. OPM (%)	20.2%	20.3%	8 bps	19.3%	93 bps	20.1%	12 bps
Beauty & Wellbeing	19.4%	19.5%	14 bps	19.2%	26 bps	19.3%	20 bps
Personal Care	22.1%	22.2%	13 bps	22.3%	-14 bps	22.0%	19 bps
Home Care	15.5%	15.8%	26 bps	15.5%	22 bps	15.7%	6 bps
Foods	23.3%	23.3%	-7 bps	23.5%	-22 bps	23.2%	7 bps

PY sales and operating profit stated ex. Ice Cream.

Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha consensus, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 5: **ULVR Q2 sales by region versus consensus**

ULVR Q2 sales by region	2Q25	2Q26	YoY Δ	Consensus 2Q26	Δ	Bernstein 2Q26	Δ
Group (EUR m)	12,567	13,046	3.8%	12,880	1.3%		
APA - Asia Pacific / Africa	5,531	5,694	2.9%	5,639	1.0%		
Americas	4,680	5,067	8.3%	4,953	2.3%		
Europe	2,356	2,285	-3.0%	2,369	-3.5%		
Group (organic growth)	3.1%	5.8%	+270 bps	4.1%	+171 bps		
APA - Asia Pacific / Africa	4.0%	8.8%	+480 bps	5.8%	+303 bps		
Americas	2.8%	5.7%	+290 bps	5.1%	+64 bps		
Europe	1.8%	-1.3%	-310 bps	0.4%	-174 bps		
Group (Price Growth)	2.1%	0.2%	-190 bps	1.7%	-148 bps		
APA - Asia Pacific / Africa	1.7%	1.5%	-20 bps	2.2%	-68 bps		
Americas	3.5%	-0.5%	-400 bps	1.7%	-218 bps		
Europe	-0.1%	-1.6%	-150 bps	0.9%	-251 bps		
Group (Volume Growth)	1.1%	5.5%	+440 bps	2.4%	+310 bps		
APA - Asia Pacific / Africa	2.2%	7.2%	+500 bps	3.6%	+364 bps		
Americas	-0.7%	6.2%	+690 bps	3.3%	+286 bps		
Europe	1.9%	0.3%	-160 bps	-0.5%	+77 bps		

Prior year sales and growth stated ex. Ice Cream.

Source: Company reports, Visible Alpha consensus, Bernstein analysis and estimates

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate Unilever Outperform with a Price Target of GBp 5,800.00 / EUR 66.90.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	27 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM	Adjusted EPS				EV/EBITDA (x)		
			Closing Price		Rel. Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
ULVR.LN (Unilever)	O	GBp	4,627.00	5,800.00	(3.4)%	EUR	3.08	3.23	3.45	13.9	13.8	12.9
UNA.NA (Unilever)	O	EUR	54.10	66.90	(1.8)%	EUR	3.08	3.23	3.45	13.9	13.8	12.9
EDME			--									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Unilever**

We set a GBp 5,800 Price Target for the ULVR listing using an EV/EBITDA multiple of 12.8x against our forward NTM+1 EBITDA estimate of EUR 12,015, whilst also making adjustments for minority stakes in some its emerging market businesses.

We currency convert the GBP 58.00 to EUR 66.90 for the UNA listing.

RISKS**Unilever**

Downside risk to our rating (or price target) include:

- (1) Emerging market economies grow slower than expected
- (2) No improvement in performance from new structure
- (3) Exceptional/restructuring costs increase in size
- (4) Competitiveness continues to worsen, or fails to improve

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIA) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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- **Credit Underperform (C-UP):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

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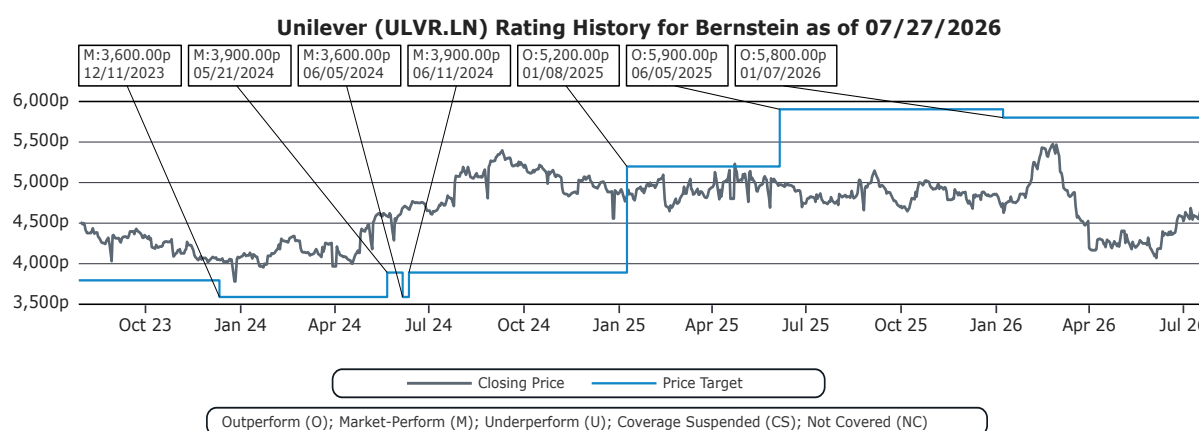
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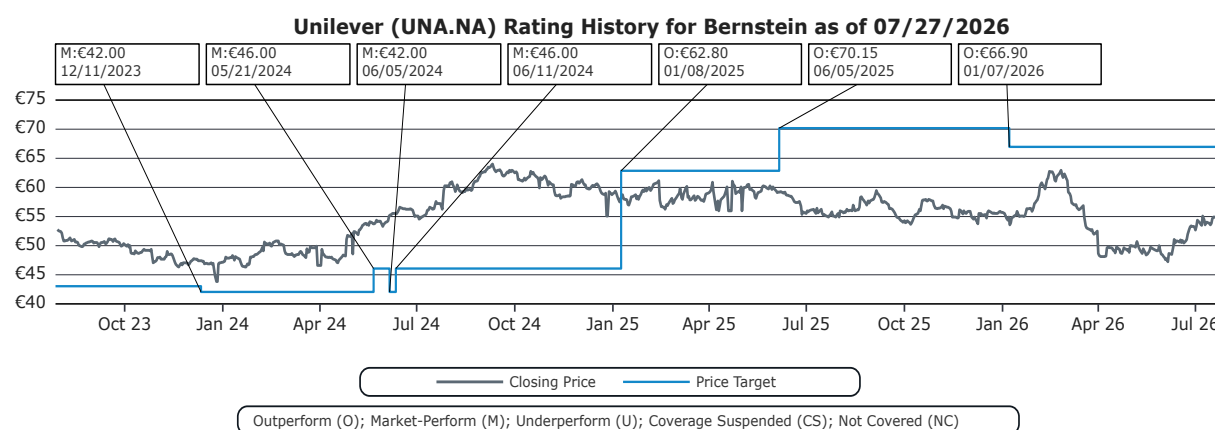
Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

PRICE CHARTS / RATINGS AND PRICE TARGET HISTORY





All price target and closing price data in the chart(s) above are denominated in the currency noted in the Ticker Table of this report.

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